

NECTAR FACTORIES
Many banksias have large, colorful flower spikes with hundreds of nectar-producing blooms. This energy-packed liquid is vital food for marsupials such as honey possums, pygmy possums, and sugar and squirrel gliders, as well as bats.

> The world's second-tallest tree, the mountain ash gum, grows here

HONEY POSSUM



COOPERATIVE FEEDERS
More than 20 honeyeater species coexist in the Blue Mountains, lapping up honey (nectar) with their brush-tipped tongues. They avoid competition by living at different altitudes, breeding at different times of year, and migration; regent honeyeaters, for example, prefer wetter, lowland sites.

REGENT HONEYEATER



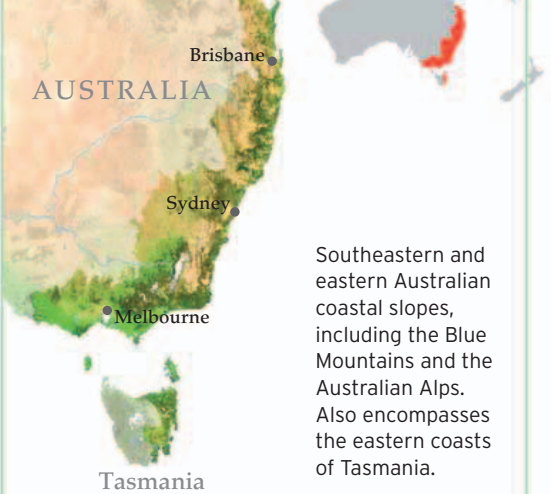
FOREST MAINTENANCE
One of the first marsupials to be described by European settlers, the long-nosed potoroo eats mycorrhizal fungi. These truffle-like underground fungi provide minerals to tree roots, receiving carbohydrates in return. The potoroo excretes fungal spores in its feces, thus spreading them to new trees.

LONG-NOSED POTOROO



LOCATION

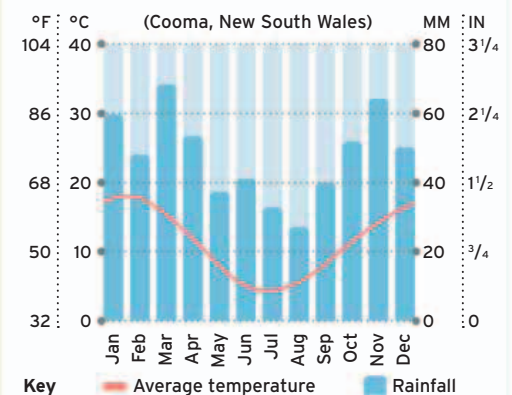
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Southeastern and eastern Australian coastal slopes, including the Blue Mountains and the Australian Alps. Also encompasses the eastern coasts of Tasmania.

CLIMATE

Southeastern Australia is generally warm and temperate, with plenty of rainfall throughout the year. Temperatures range from the subtropical in southern Queensland to low enough for snowfall accumulation in Tasmania's hills. Higher altitudes have the most rainfall.



RABBIT PLAGUE

Perhaps Australia's worst invasive species, the European rabbit has devastated huge areas of vegetation, killed trees by bark-ringing, and outcompeted many herbivores. Even if 90 percent are destroyed in an area, the remainder restore the original population in 12-18 months because of the rabbits' rapid rate of reproduction.

